



Purple patch: Ellyse Perry of the Royal Challengers Bangalore amassed 347 runs at an astounding average of 69.40 and a strike rate of 125.72, while also claiming seven wickets at an economy rate of 6.81. SPORTZPICS/WPL

boundary-finding skills, valuable lessons ahead of the T20 World Cup later this year.

The women's team has been struggling with its tail's inability to contribute with the bat. In the 2017



World Cup final, India fell short against England by nine runs, with the lower-order batters, including Shikha Pandey, Poonam Yadav, Rajeshwari Gayakwad, and Jhulan Goswami, only managing to score five runs during a relatively comfortable chase. This issue has also affected teams like Mumbai Indians and Delhi Capitals in the WPL, costing them a place in the final and the trophy. Instead of patiently accumulating runs, impulsive hitting and attempts to hit glory shots have been the preferred approach, something that head coach Amol Muzumdar must address.

India opener and vice-captain Smriti Mandhana has been known to make similar errors, but in the final match, she adjusted her approach to score 31 runs off 39 balls. Typically, she might have been critical of herself for approaching what seemed

Smashing effort: Ellyse Perry's explosive 58 runs off 37 balls for the Royal Challengers Bangalore against UP Warriorz included a powerful shot that broke the window of a sponsor's car parked near the boundary.

SPORTZPICS/WPL

like an easy chase in this manner. "We wanted to take it easy and get the top four to finish the job. We had time, and we didn't want to lose wickets and trigger panic," she revealed later.

Smriti had a remarkable tournament as captain, too. Widely loved, easygoing, and not one to dictate terms, Smriti underlines that the factor that made all the difference in her leadership from last season to this one was time.

"There was a meeting post-season last year with the management

HONOUR ROLL

 Orange cap

Ellyse Perry (RCB)



347

RUNS IN NINE MATCHES

 Purple cap

Shreyanka Patil (RCB)



13

WICKETS IN EIGHT MATCHES

MVP

Deepti Sharma (UPW)



295

RUNS & 10 WICKETS IN EIGHT MATCHES

MOST SIXES

Shafali Verma (DC)



20

SIXES